



Baby Mafia

Shi Jinsong has just the thing for the underworld family, a baby carriage mounted with machine guns



Giant spiral in Norway sky

While cheesy forums went crazy, calling it proof that the Pastmaster really exists, the more serious sources revealed a mere Russian missile failure as the cause

Unwind

Bookmarks

A monthly update of great sites to browse through.

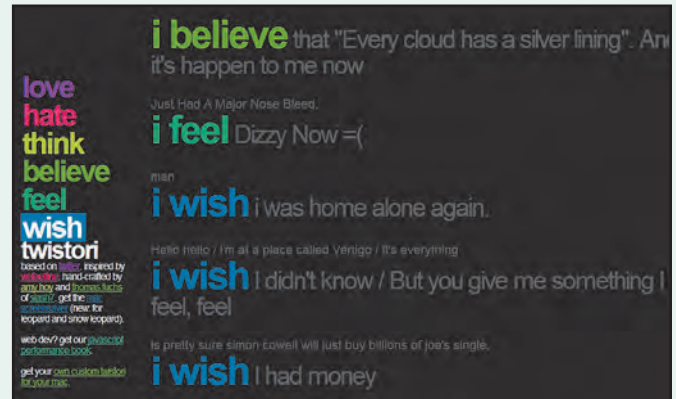
Whatport80: A toned down, safe for work site that chronicles all the drama on the internet, and explains the logic (or lack thereof) in some of the more extreme forms of madness prevailing on the tubes.

Artpad: Artpad is a quick and dirty online painting tool, with a few brushes, frames, effects and the very useful history tracking tool.

Aviary Myna: Cloud based audio-editing, just upload the files you want to work on, edit them, and download them again or share them on the Aviary network. We just wish the edited versions could be messaged to our mobile phones.

Thewhalehunt: A strange story about a real whale hunt told through images and hearbeats.

www.twistori.com



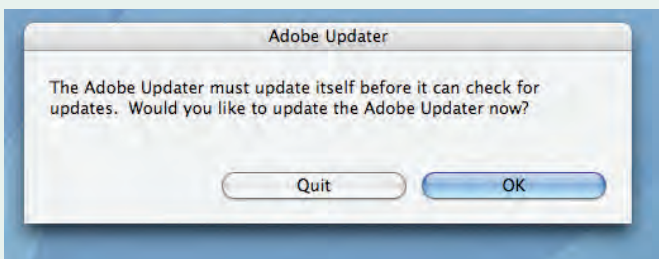
Inspired by wefeelfine.org (featured in DigitTV), Tiwstori applies the same concept exclusively to Twitter, but a few extra words thrown in to watch. Click on any of the coloured words on the bar on the left, and the tweets start pouring in in real time, as in the murmurs menu on wefeelfine.org. No stats or history at this point of time though, but the “believe” segment is often outrageous and funny. This site is NSFW, as we discovered to our expense. There is a desktop client available exclusively for Mac users.



Image Credit: Ramiro Perez Clare Nash

tech art: 3D Fractals

A sub-form of generative art, 3D fractals involve creating artwork by feeding in mathematical formulae into renderers or programmes made for that purpose. There are many fractal enthusiasts, and this particular piece, known as “Furnace” is from the hobbyist web site www.rfactals.net, made using a software known as Incendia.



NEWS

Twitter compromised by DNS attack



Users of Twitter were greeting with something far more threatening than the Fail Whale on 18th December. There was a message that proclaimed that “This site has been hacked by the Iranian Cyber Army”. At first it looked like this was a rather belated response to the six week long #IranElections trend on Twitter, where tweeples from around the world rallied for the support of Democracy in Iran using a combination of tweets, proxy servers, information and in some cases, disinformation. A sustained six weeks effort is in itself a terribly long time on Twitter timescales, but a retaliation after six months is even longer. It later emerged that this was an attack on the DNS vulnerability, something that internet gurus have been trying to fix for two decades now. Fortunately, this means that accounts on Twitter had not been compromised. As a large share of tweeters used third party tools and applications, the steady stream of tweets was not really interrupted despite the defacement.